Westbrook City Council

~ Regular Meeting ~

Date: Monday, September 14, 2026
Time: 6:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1226754892
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_09142026-1028

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *This Regular meeting and the Committee of the Whole that followed it the same night share this one video recording; this summary covers only the Regular meeting portion (roughly the first hour, before the Council recessed into executive session). See the separate September 14, 2026 Committee of the Whole summary for the second half of the evening. For complete context, nuance, and anything not covered here, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Mayor's Message

9/11 Remembrance, Winter Heating Assistance, Public Comment Changes & Transit Pass Update [8:49]

Discussion Summary

Mayor Morse marked the 25th anniversary of September 11th and described attending the Westbrook Fire Department's annual awards banquet that same weekend, thanking Fire Chief Stephen Sloan and the department.

With fuel costs high heading into colder weather, the Mayor urged residents to contact Westbrook General Assistance (519-7015, at the Community Center, 426 Bridge St.) for help identifying eligible heating-assistance programs, including a local church-administered fuel program and Cumberland County's HEAP/LIHEAP programs (administered through the Opportunity Alliance).

Two public comment procedure changes: written comments intended for the meeting record must now reach the City Clerk's office by 10 AM the morning of the meeting (late submissions can still be forwarded, and in-person/Zoom comment remains available); and speakers will now be asked only to state their name and whether they are a Westbrook resident, rather than their full home address, to reduce a privacy barrier to participation (a formal Council Rules of Order amendment is being drafted for future consideration).

The Student Transit Pass Program launched August 31 (the first day of school); early reports are positive, some early off-hours bus trips on Monroe Avenue on the first day have been addressed, and Metro reports students are using a variety of routes beyond the downtown/high school corridor.

The Mayor closed with an extended personal tribute to Dolly Parton following her recent death.

Key Decisions

✓ Informational — no vote taken.

Action Items

None.

City Council Messages & First Public Comment

Police/Transportation Kudos, Disc Golf Plug, DA Candidate & Gorham Warehouse Concern [18:21]

Discussion Summary

Councilor Faulkingham praised the Police Department and School Transportation Department for their fast, thoughtful response to a parent's concern about a kindergartner's bus-stop safety. President Munro promoted the Westbrook Education Foundation's inaugural disc golf tournament at Sunset Ridge Golf Course.

Stephanie Anderson, a former 28-year Cumberland County District Attorney now running for the office again, introduced her campaign and argued the DA race has significant local stakes for Westbrook; Councilor Turcotte thanked her for speaking.

A remote commenter raised concern about a proposed Amazon warehouse in Gorham, citing likely overnight truck traffic through Westbrook via Route 25, and urged the City to formally oppose the project or coordinate with Gorham.

Key Decisions

✓ **Informational — no vote taken.**

Action Items

None.

Second & Final Reading / Resolve

Orders 2026-89, -90 — Pump Station Doors & Forestry Mulcher Rental (Consent) [27:54]

Discussion Summary

Both first-read August 3, 2026: $8,033.03 for replacement pump station doors at Gray Goose and Brydon Farms, and a $7,500 forestry mulcher rental plus related vendor-list amendment. No discussion.

Key Decisions

✓ **Passed together by unanimous roll call, 6–0.**

Action Items

None.

Resolve 2026-16 — November 3, 2026 State General Election Hours [29:44]

Discussion Summary

Sets polling hours for the November 3, 2026 State General Election, per standard Clerk's office request.

Key Decisions

✓ **Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.**

Action Items

None.

New Business — Orders (One Reading Required)

Order 2026-91 — Hot Rods & Heroes Car Show Permit [31:33]

Discussion Summary

Approves a Major Mass Gathering Permit for the annual Hot Rods & Heroes Car Show (Bill Dodge Auto Group, 4 Saunders Way), a veteran-support fundraiser, scheduled Sunday, October 18, 2026 (rain date October 25), with an anticipated crowd over 1,000.

Key Decisions

✓ **Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.**

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-92 — Presumpscot Regional Land Trust Trail Challenge Sponsorship [33:05]

Discussion Summary

Authorizes $500 in open space funds to sponsor the Presumpscot Regional Land Trust's 2026 Summer Trail Challenge, a community hiking-passport program, for the second consecutive year.

Key Decisions

✓ **Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.**

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-93 — Public Safety Building LED Lighting — Vendor Swap [35:07]

Discussion Summary

Amends Order 2026-52 to swap the Public Safety Building LED lighting project's electrical vendor from Gilman Electric to Northeast Electric/Rockingham Electric (unable to source required parts), at the same contract price.

Key Decisions

✓ **Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.**

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-94 — Lincoln Street Sidewalk/Roadway Project — Asphalt Vendor Amendment [37:00]

Discussion Summary

Amends Order 2025-81 (Lincoln Street sidewalk/roadway project) to add Dayton Sand & Gravel and Thyng Paving as approved vendors for asphalt handwork at $180/ton versus original contractor R.J. Grondin's $375/ton rate, with no change to the overall project budget. Councilor Chau asked whether the lower per-ton rate should reduce the total budget; Director Eric Dudley explained the original bid's handwork quantity estimate was actually too low, so the project remains on budget overall despite the per-ton savings, and the project is now nearly $200,000 under its total budget and at substantial completion.

Key Decisions

✓ **Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.**

Action Items
None.

Order 2026-95 — Impaired Driving Enforcement Grant — Additional Funds [42:37]

Discussion Summary
Amends Order 2025-171 to accept an additional $2,500 in Maine Bureau of Highway Safety impaired-driving enforcement grant funds, bringing that grant's total to $6,122.

Key Decisions
✓ **Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0.**

Action Items
None.

New Business — Orders (First Reading, Two Readings Required)

Order 2026-96 — Federal Asset Forfeiture Funds — Acceptance Only [43:27]

Discussion Summary
Accepts $6,357.10 in federal asset forfeiture funds tied to a large-scale methamphetamine investigation (Westbrook PD's officer assigned to the FBI Safe Streets Task Force). A floor amendment struck “and expenditure” from the order, since no specific expenditure plan exists yet — this is an acceptance-only action for now.

Key Decisions
✓ **Floor amendment passed by show of hands.**

✓ **Order as amended passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0 (first reading).**

Action Items
None.

Order 2026-97 — Emergency-Authorized Police Vehicle Replacement [46:05]

Discussion Summary
Confirms an emergency-authorized $29,000 purchase of a used 2023 Ford Explorer XLT to replace an aging vehicle in the Police Department's Criminal Division, under the Mayor's emergency procurement authority, since used vehicles meeting the City's criteria don't typically stay available long enough for the normal two-reading process.

Key Decisions
✓ **Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0 (first reading).**

Action Items
None.

Order 2026-98 — Byrne JAG Grant — Police Training Equipment [48:09]

Discussion Summary

Accepts a $14,447 Edward Byrne Memorial Justice Assistance Grant for police training equipment: a Pro-Sit 360 reactive target, Taser batteries, and Taser cartridges.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0 (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-99 — Motorola Body-Worn & Cruiser Camera Agreement [49:42]

Discussion Summary

Authorizes a five-year, $291,810.32 agreement with Motorola Solutions for replacement body-worn and cruiser cameras, chosen over a slightly cheaper Axon bid (by $1,500) for a better data-storage package; Year 1 costs are covered by reallocating CIP funds originally set aside for cruiser replacement, and Years 2–5 will be funded from the Police Detail Fee revenue line.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0 (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-100 — Pershing Way Pump Station Roof Replacement [53:45]

Discussion Summary

Authorizes $32,643 to G&E Roofing (sole-source, given their existing maintenance relationship on the City's other pump stations) for a full roof replacement at the 27-year-old Pershing Way Pump Station.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0 (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-101 — Plate Compactor Purchase [55:32]

Discussion Summary

Authorizes a $7,500 Husqvarna vibratory plate compactor purchase from MB Tractor & Equipment for Public Services.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0 (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-102 — 2026–2029 Collective Bargaining Agreement, Teamsters Local 340 [57:13]

Discussion Summary

Approves the 2026–2029 Collective Bargaining Agreement with Teamsters Local 340 (the Westbrook General Unit, now a smaller group of roughly 20 administrative/clerical positions after a new, separately-negotiated Essential Services Unit was carved out of the former bargaining unit). The agreement includes a 3% annual

cost-of-living increase each year and a new longevity bonus for employees with 20+ years of continuous City service.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 6–0 (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Closing & Executive Session

No Second Public Comment, No Referrals — Council Enters Executive Session

[59:28]

Discussion Summary

No second public comment, no referrals, and no committee reports. The Council voted to enter executive session under 1 M.R.S. §405(6)(E) (consultation with the City's attorney). The Regular meeting portion of the evening ends here; the Committee of the Whole convened separately roughly 45 minutes later (see the companion summary).

Key Decisions

✓ Motion to enter executive session passed by show of hands.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase), which is shared with the Committee of the Whole session that followed it the same night. The audio was downloaded with Downie 4 and transcribed with speaker diarization using MacWhisper. Claude (Anthropic's AI) cross-checked names and figures against the official packet and the city council roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the presiding officer) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

Produced by Westbrook Currents — westbrookcurrents.com